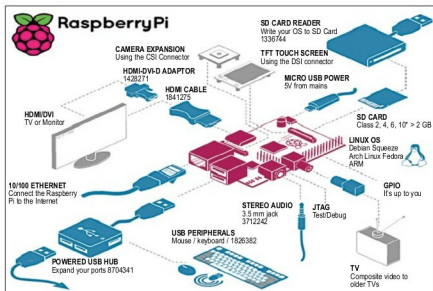


Raspberry Pi: A Tinkerer's Dream Come True

The Raspberry Pi has spurred so much interest in last one year that we decided to uncover what makes it such a great catalyst for innovation



These endless possibilities with a Raspberry Pi, is how every Tinkerer's dream comes true!

DILIN ANAND AND SNEHA AMBASTHA

The Raspberry Pi board, lovingly called 'the Pi,' is not just a developer board but also a small easy-to-work with computer at a rock-bottom price. You can use it to connect peripheral devices, or even to control entire systems. It gives you the power to convert an idea into reality in a snap.

The thought behind the creation of the Pi was to replace expensive computers from schools' science labs. What happened, however, was that it evolved into a board now used by hobbyists, startups and researchers, and even in industrial applications!

P. Chow Reddy, managing director, Interleaved Technologies informs that the Raspberry Pi initially faced a problem in its entry into industrial applications because of the 'Made for

Kids' caption it carried. This later turned out to be a blessing in disguise. The fact that this board is so simple that even kids can work on it has led to it becoming the *numero uno* choice for rapidly prototyping ideas that keep popping up in innovators' heads all over the world.

P. Chow Reddy adds, "At the EFY launch of Raspberry Pi during the first Electronics Rocks session by Eben Upton through video conference, a few demos on applications were mind boggling. The most interesting demo over there was controlling of Raspberry Pi with wrist watch ez430 from Texas Instruments."

Let's you squeeze out every bit of CPU power

The Pi comes with a CPU that performs similarly to the Pentium II which was introduced in 1997. Its GPU performance is comparable to a XBOX

gaming console of 2001.

One little hack that users of the Pi have been doing is to overclock the device from its normal 700MHz clock speed to speeds of 800MHz or, in some cases, even 1000MHz.

This lets you run applications faster, by making use of the higher compute power now available on tap from the board. There have been users who have clocked the Pi at such high speeds that they needed to use an additional heat-sink and cooling to keep the CPU (a Broadcom system-on-chip used in mobile phones) from burning up.

Connect electronics lying around to your Pi

This little ₹ 3500 computer can do a lot of the things your desktop PC can do for just a fraction of the price. Some of its hottest features include being able to work with peripherals that were previously the sole property of a traditional computer.

USB keyboards, mice, HDMI monitors and projectors, music systems, memory cards—everything fits in. It even supports an RCA connector to be able to output video to your older TVs. It means you can use your Pi with most IT and consumer electronics devices without having to seriously re-engineer the board.

Some exciting enhancements

From interfacing through inter-integrated circuit and display serial interface buses to slapping on IR receivers, sensors and camera boards, the Pi is built to handle a lot of additional hardware without breaking a sweat. Some of the things you can do with it are:

Move your Pi. Lift things, open